

Why wouldn't a camera pro love this phone!

Such is Oppo's confidence on the Find X9 Ultra

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Oppo has had an interesting journey with flagships in India. The Find series – super popular for its cameras globally – wasn't really available here. For years, if you wanted an Oppo Ultra here, you had to know someone who knew someone who'd bring one back from a global launch. The X7 Ultra, the X8 Ultra – they were the kind of phones that made you want to switch your SIM card immediately, and some even would have if only the menus weren't entirely in Chinese.

That changes now, with the Oppo Find X9 Ultra and Oppo Find X9s available in India. Two phones that can make a massive difference to Oppo's portfolio, to consumer usage, and to India's evolving relationship with premium smartphones. The S keeps things familiar; the Ultra is the one that has everyone.

In an exclusive conversation with Simon Liu, Director of Imaging at Oppo, and Goldee Patnaik, Head of Communications, Oppo India, they walked me through plenty of behind-the-scenes detail and Oppo's India

mindset. Spoiler alert, it's really something that is intriguing.

What Hasselblad Actually Means

The Hasselblad partnership has been a crucial part of Oppo's story

for several generations now, but since the Find phones are have only been around for a couple of years in India, it's fair to be skeptical of co-branding arrangements in the camera world. So what does it actually mean in practice?

Liu's answer was very technical and specific. The most visible element of this is HNCS (Hasselblad Natural Colour

Science), which governs how the phone renders skin tones and human subjects. Oppo calibrates this tuning directly against the Hasselblad X2D, a medium-format camera that costs more than most laptops.

"When you can take identical pictures with a phone that are the same as a Hasselblad and there's definitely

no AI in the Hasselblad, it's directly meeting the needs of that kind of photographer," Liu said. "So why wouldn't a professional love this phone?"

Beyond the color science, the Hasselblad influence shows up in portrait gradient rendering (how light wraps around faces), the XPAN widescreen panoramic mode, and the physical button layout – including that orange shutter. These are details that an enthusiast photographer always notices.

AI That Disappears

If you've attended or seen a smartphone launch lately, you've heard the word "AI" roughly six hundred times. So what's actually different about how Oppo thinks about it?

Patnaik said a line that really stuck with me: "The

moment you know AI is doing something, the charm is lost."

His argument: AI's best role in a smartphone isn't to announce itself – it's to make things quietly better. Oppo organizes its AI approach around three areas: imaging excellence (photos that look good without you thinking about it), creativity (tools to express yourself), and productivity (translation, contextual suggestions, time-saving workflows).

Simon Liu took a more global view in his approach. "Technology is all the same, globally," he said. "AI is a general tool we use to solve almost any kind of issue. If it's proven efficient in solving a problem in the US or China, there's no reason to do it differently in India."

What both of them kept coming back to was "invisible AI" – the kind that runs silently in the background, handling lag reduction, app efficiency, and camera processing without requiring you to tap a button that is labeled "AI Enhance." **d**



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